Budget Book

Last Updated 09/25/25

budget figure.

GENERAL FUND

The General Fund provides the funding for the core services of the City of Medford. Revenues include property taxes, state aid, excise taxes, and other locally generated revenues. General Fund expenditures cover the City Departments as well as the Medford Public Schools. Departmental expenditures are categorized by function as either: General Government, Education, Public Safety, Public Works, Culture & Recreation, Human Services, as well as shared expenses for expenditures that are shared by multiple departments, like utility costs, employee benefits, state assessments, and debt.

ENTERPRISE FUND

The Enterprise fund is a special fund that was created, under MGL chapter 44 Section 53 F½, for specific business purposes. These funds are designed to be self-sustaining, where the revenue generated by the fund is used to cover the expenditures. The City of Medford has one combined Sewer/Water Enterprise Fund.

REVOLVING FUNDS

Revolving Funds are special funds that are created under MGL chapter 44 Section 53 E½, designed to roll from one fiscal year to another. Not including School Revolving Funds, the City of Medford has ten Revolving Funds. The revolving funds are as follows as listed in the City's Ordinances: the Community Garden Commission Revolving Fund, Hormel Stadium Revolving Fund, Immunization Clinics Revolving Fund, Tobacco Education Revolving Fund, Wright's Pond and Tufts Pool Revolving Fund, Recreation Program Revolving Fund, Compost Bins Revolving Fund, Water Meters Revolving Fund, Trash/Recycling Revolving Fund, and Chevalier Theatre Revolving Fund. The Tax Title Revolving Fund was created under MGL chapter 60 section 15B.

CPA FUND

The Community Preservation Act under MGL Ch. 44B was accepted and passed by the City of Medford with the November 2015 ballot vote. The City adopted the CPA at a rate of 1.5% property tax levy surcharge. The CPA fund was created as a special fund and started collecting revenues in fiscal year 2018.

OVERLAY

Overlay is a single account to fund abatements and exemptions of committed real and personal property taxes for any fiscal year. The overlay amount is determined by the Board of Assessors and may be raised in the tax rate without appropriation. For FY26, the City is planning to raise $300,000 for overlay.

years.

FY26 Recap

FY 2026 Recap	
Property Tax Calculations	**FY 2025**
FY 2025 Levy Limit	153,506,549.98
2.50%	3,837,663.75
New Growth	2,200,000.00
Total FY2024 Property Taxes	**159,544,213.73**
Revenue	
Property Taxes	159,544,213.73
Local Receipts	22,525,100.00
State Aid	35,168,741.00
Indirect Costs - Water/Sewer Fund	2,163,030.32
Sale of Lots & Graves/Perpetual Care	363,056.40
Casino - Surrounding Communities	185,034.84
Total Revenue	**219,949,176.29**
Non Budgeted Expenses	
State Assessments	12,810,323.00
Tax Title	25,000.00
Snow & Ice Deficit	802,781.50
Overlay	300,000.00
Total Available for Budget:	**206,011,069.92**

		FY24 Expenses	FY25 Expenses as of 5/17/2025	FY26 Available Fund Balance
Community Garden Commission	Office of Planning, Development, & Sustainability	2,471.00	619.00	4,311.00
Hormel Stadium	Department of Public Works	102,679.00	104,257.00	(26,165.00)
Immunization Clinics	Board of Health	59,469.00	116,894.00	156,922.00
Tobacco Education	Board of Health	-	-	147,692.00
Wright's Pond and Tufts Pool	Department of Public Works	104,642.00	63,714.00	147,391.00
Recreation Program	Recreation & Executive	361,070.00	318,003.00	211,210.00
Compost Bins	Office of Planning, Development, & Sustainability	-	-	892.00
Water Meters	Department of Public Works	-	-	181,504.00
Trash/Recycling	Department of Public Works	7,576.00	58,400.00	303,011.00
Chevalier Theatre	Treasurer	234,076.00	139,128.00	90,430.00
Totals:		**871,983.00**	**801,015.00**	**1,217,198.00**

GENERAL FUND:

REVENUES:

Property Taxes	139,163,666	145,984,648	159
Local Receipts	24,717,591	21,000,000	22,
State Aid	33,806,036	34,004,353	35,
Transfer in from Special Revenue	258,168	217,407	185
Transfer in from Enterprise	1,600,000	2,120,618	2,1
Transfer in from Trust Funds	228,764	314,816	36
TOTAL GENERAL FUND REVENUES	**199,774,225**	**203,641,841**	**2**

EXPENDITURES:

GENERAL GOVERNMENT

Executive Office	633,310	673,270	
Contractual Agreements	2,227,559	1,575,000	
Legislative	304,233	312,689	
Clerk	368,545	406,364	
Finance/Procurement	749,643	854,314	
Assessor	557,119	646,783	
Treasurer/Collector	680,911	757,494	
Law	375,196	530,036	
Information Technology	392,021	357,366	
Human Resources	215,877	269,480	
Elections	373,491	327,435	
Planning, Development, & Sustainability	478,481	819,207	
PEG Access (Cable)	166,525	208,424	
Building	1,012,093	1,031,543	
Electrical	683,773	678,805	
Licensing Commission	4,500	5,800	
Conservation Commission	5,209	7,500	
Board of Appeals	9,750	12,500	
Community Development Board	6,900	9,200	
Bicycle Commission	1,500	1,500	
TOTAL GENERAL GOVERNMENT	**9,246,636**	**9,484,710**	**9**

Civil Defense	9,140	9,840	
TOTAL PUBLIC SAFETY	**29,877,766**	**31,111,886**	**3**
EDUCATION			
City Public Schools	71,224,615	83,000,000	8
TOTAL EDUCATION	**71,224,615**	**83,000,000**	**8**
PUBLIC WORKS			
Facilities	1,800,442	1,838,745	
Engineering	518,905	547,752	
Highway	11,104,901	12,839,686	1
Forestry	545,614	623,989	
Parks	824,028	957,578	
Cemetery	1,070,438	1,118,050	
TOTAL PUBLIC WORKS	**15,864,328**	**17,925,800**	**1**
HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES			
Health	628,288	810,978	
Veteran's	286,396	444,361	
Diversity, Equity, & Inclusion	107,537	118,502	
Council on Aging	258,516	277,157	
TOTAL HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES	**1,280,738**	**1,650,998**	
CULTURE & RECREATION			
Library	2,012,799	2,247,934	
Recreation	586,723	607,787	
Chevalier Theatre (part of Facilities for FY26)	31,369	32,000	
Historical Commission	20,338	35,000	
Historical District Commission	-	5,000	
Hormel Stadium Commission	4,500	5,400	
TOTAL CULTURE & RECREATION	**2,655,730**	**2,933,121**	
DEBT SERVICE			
Debt	5,091,124	5,351,319	

TOTAL ASSESSMENTS	**12,483,520**	**13,028,481**	**1**
EMPLOYEE BENEFITS			
Contributory Retirement	15,318,597	16,197,493	1
Non-contributory Pensions	85,897	84,043	
Worker's Compensation	976,773	788,000	
Unemployment Compensation	17,866	50,000	
Insurance	25,854,981	27,582,551	3
Senior Work Off	26,833	-	
TOTAL EMPLOYEE BENEFITS	**42,280,948**	**44,702,087**	**4**
MUNICIPAL INSURANCE			
Municipal Insurance	696,857	745,000	
TOTAL MUNICIPAL INSURANCE	**696,857**	**745,000**	
BUDGET TRANSFERS OUT OF GF			
Transfer to Capital Projects	3,000,000	-	
Transfer to Trust Funds	11,000,000	-	
TOTAL BUDGET TRANSFERS OUT OF GF	**14,000,000**	**-**	
GENERAL FUND TOTAL EXPENDITURES:	**204,702,261**	**209,933,402**	**2**
ENTERPRISE FUND:			
REVENUES:			
User Charges	28,020,167	29,429,218	3
Liens	1,306,838	1,372,555	
TOTAL ENTERPRISE FUND REVENUES	**29,327,005**	**30,801,773**	**3**
EXPENDITURES:			
WATER/SEWER			
Public Services	3,510,449	4,582,271	
Debt	1,409,044	1,743,644	

CITY GRAND TOTAL ALL FUNDS REVENUES:	**229,101,230**	**234,443,614**	**2**
CITY GRAND TOTAL ALL FUNDS EXPENDITURES:	**234,622,702**	**240,735,175**	**2**

and affordable housing and (ii) the acquisition, preservation, rehabilitation and restoration of historic resources. The provisions of the CPA must be accepted by the voters of the city or town at an election after such provisions have first been accepted by either a vote of the legislative body of the city or town or an initiative petition signed by 5% of its registered voters.

A city or town may approve a surcharge of up to 3% (but not less than 1% under certain circumstances) and may make an additional commitment of funds by dedicating revenue other than state or federal funds, provided that the total funds collected do not exceed 3% of the real property tax levy, less any exemptions adopted. In the event that the municipality shall no longer dedicate all or part of the additional funds to community preservation, the surcharge on the real property tax levy of not less than 1% shall remain in effect, provided that any such change must be approved pursuant to the same process as acceptance of the CPA. The surcharge is not counted in the total taxes assessed for the purpose of determining the permitted levy amount under Proposition 2½. A city or town may revoke its acceptance of the provisions of the CPA at any time after 5 years from the date of such acceptance and may change the amount of the surcharge or the exemptions to the surcharge at any time, including reducing the surcharge to 1% and committing additional municipal funds as outlined above, provided that any such revocation or change must be approved pursuant to the same process as acceptance of the CPA.

Any city or town that accepts the provisions of the CPA will receive annual state matching grants to supplement amounts raised by its surcharge and dedication of revenue. The state matching funds are raised from certain recording and filing fees of the registers of deeds. Those amounts are deposited into a state trust fund and are distributed to cities and towns that have accepted the provisions of the CPA, which distributions are not subject to annual appropriation by the state legislature. The amount distributed to each city and town is based on a statutory formula and the total state distribution made to any city or town may not exceed 100% of the amount raised locally by the surcharge on the real property tax levy.

The amounts raised by the surcharge on real property taxes and received in state matching funds are required to be deposited in a dedicated community preservation fund. Each city or town that accepts the provisions of the CPA is required to establish a community preservation committee to study the community preservation needs of the community and to make recommendations to the legislative body of the city or town regarding the community preservation projects that should be funded from the community preservation fund. Upon the recommendations of the committee, the legislative body of the city or town may appropriate amounts from the fund for permitted community preservation purposes or may reserve amounts for spending in future fiscal years, provided that at least 10% of the total annual revenues to the fund must be spent or set aside for open space purposes, 10% for historic preservation purposes and 10% for affordable housing purposes.

2017	1,232,810.00	-	1,232,810.00
2018	1,248,308.66	214,169.00	1,462,477.66
2019	1,316,402.50	249,828.00	1,566,230.50
2020	1,409,899.07	336,074.00	1,745,973.07
2021	1,476,495.81	421,638.00	1,898,133.81
2022	1,535,516.62	463,500.00	1,999,016.62
2023	1,626,374.94	583,690.00	2,210,064.94
2024	1,692,060.33	380,713.57	2,072,773.90
2025	1,808,497.03	260,422.97	2,068,920.00
2026	1,897,383.00	301,660.00	2,199,043.00

Community Preservation Act (CPA) Multi-Year Actuals and Estimated

Community Preservation Fund (875)

Program #	Name	FY18 Approved	FY19 Approved	FY20 Approved	FY21 Approved	FY22 Approved	FY23 Approved	FY24 Approved	FY25 Proposed	FY26 Proposed
671	OPEN SPACE	152,623.00	157,483.00	146,000.00	174,640.00	179,006.00	183,481.15	223,351.50	206,892.00	219,904.40
672	COMMUNITY HOUSING	152,623.00	157,483.00	146,000.00	174,640.00	179,006.00	366,962.30	229,351.50	310,338.00	549,761.00
673	HISTORIC PRESERVATION	152,623.00	157,483.00	146,000.00	174,640.00	179,006.00	183,481.15	229,351.50	206,892.00	219,904.40
674	GENERAL RESERVE	1,068,363.00	1,102,379.00	1,022,000.00	1,222,480.00	1,253,042.00	1,100,886.90	1,490,784.75	1,241,352.00	1,099,521.00
	ADMIN							114,675.75	103,446.00	109,952.20
		1,526,232.00	**1,574,828.00**	**1,460,000.00**	**1,746,400.00**	**1,790,060.00**	**1,834,811.50**	**2,287,515.00**	**2,068,920.00**	**2,199,043.00**

Note: For FY26, proposed budget includes estimated state match of 15.1% of collected revenue $1,897,364.

position going forward.

As with any municipal entity, the City's largest expense is personnel costs. The City considers the status of its collective bargaining negotiations and projects cost of living adjustments for each group when it prepares its long-range financial plan. As the Chief Executive Officer, the Mayor is in tune with each department's goals and utilizes her vision for the organization's priorities. She provides significant input to the long-range financial planning effort, to ensure goals can be reached in future years. The City also incorporates forecasted cost changes such as:

- trash and recycling collection
- organizational staffing needs as a result of policy changes
- personnel needs across the organization

The City utilizes year-to-year inflation trends to inform future expenses. Given that the City relies on a number of grant funds, the City also considers changes to grant funding and ensures that it is prepared for any revenue changes.

A ballot initiative to increase the City's contribution to Medford's Schools and provide additional funding for road maintenance was passed in November, 2024. Additionally, the City is in the process of planning for the construction of a new high school, which will be partially funded by State grants but will necessarily involve a debt exclusion.

FY 27 is expected to be a challenging year given a $25 million bond authorization that will start to be repaid which is estimated to be $1.7 million per year as well as known increases in solid waste and compositing and anticipated increases in health insurance as has been the trend in the last few years

Culture and Recreation	2,871,290.00	2,935,894.03	3,001,951.64	3,069,495.55
Debt Service	5,060,178.00	6,117,715.02	6,230,608.14	6,172,358.14
Benefits	50,490,540.00	53,270,918.50	56,102,605.14	59,793,279.80
	205,852,504.00	213,432,585.09	220,647,782.70	228,763,505.91
Water/Sewer	29,277,779.00	30,156,112.37	31,060,795.74	31,992,619.61
Total Appropriations	235,130,283.00	243,588,697.46	251,708,578.44	260,756,125.52
Medford Preliminary Recap Projections				
Tax Title	25,000.00	20,000.00	20,000.00	20,000.00
Cherry Sheet Offsets	149,522.00	156,998.10	164,848.01	173,090.41
Snow and Ice deficit	802,781.50	500,000.00	500,000.00	500,000.00
Cherry Sheet Charges	12,810,323.00	13,450,839.15	14,123,381.11	14,829,550.16
Overlay	500,000.00	500,000.00	500,000.00	500,000.00
Total to be Raised	249,417,909.50	258,216,534.71	267,016,807.56	276,778,766.09
Receipts				
Cherry Sheets	35,168,741.00	36,927,178.05	38,773,536.95	40,712,213.80
Local Receipts	22,000,000.00	22,150,000.00	22,150,000.00	22,500,000.00
Enterprise Funds	31,440,809.32	32,226,829.55	33,032,500.29	33,858,312.80
	88,609,550.32	91,304,007.60	93,956,037.24	97,070,526.60
Other Available:				
Casino Funds	185,034.84	188,735.54	192,510.25	196,360.45
Sale of Lots	105,300.00	107,406.00	109,554.12	111,745.20
Perpetual Care	257,756.40	262,911.53	268,169.76	273,533.15
	548,091.24	559,053.06	570,234.13	581,638.81
Estimated Levy Capacity	153,506,550.00	160,344,213.75	166,352,819.09	172,511,639.57
Prop 2 1/2	3,837,663.75	4,008,605.34	4,158,820.48	4,312,790.99
New Growth	3,000,000.00	2,000,000.00	2,000,000.00	2,000,000.00
	160,344,213.75	166,352,819.09	172,511,639.57	178,824,430.56
Total Estimated Revenue	249,501,855.31	258,215,879.76	267,037,910.94	276,476,595.97
Available (Shortfall)	83,945.81	(654.95)	21,103.38	(302,170.12)

ATTACHMENTS

Title	Description
4 Year Financial Forecast (/resource/cg-...	

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